Builders at UVA

Constitution and Bylaws - 2026-2027

Adoption date: September 29, 2026.

Article I - Name

The organization is Builders at UVA, also known as builders@uva. It was founded in September 2026. Its shared email is team@uva.builders.

Article II - Purpose

The organization builds a culture of independent creation at UVA. It brings students together to work on their own ideas, learn from founders, and help each other go beyond their perceived limitations. Activities include founder talks and Q&A sessions, shared work sessions, and project demonstrations and feedback. Members may pursue commercial or noncommercial projects.

The organization is student-led and independent. Its officers manage its activities and finances. Guests, sponsors, advisors, and University resources do not direct the organization or select its officers.

Article III - Membership

Membership is open to all currently enrolled UVA students who support the purpose and register on the organization's roster. No competitive application, interview, audition, prior technical experience, completed project, dues, initiation, probation, or pledge process is required. The form at https://uva.builders/apply is an open registration and member-expertise survey, not a selection process. Participation is voluntary.

Builders at UVA does not restrict its membership, programs, or activities on the basis of any protected characteristics/statuses - including all protected characteristics/statuses listed in University Policy HRM-009 (Preventing and Addressing Discrimination and Harassment: https://uvapolicy.virginia.edu/policy/HRM-009).

The organization will provide an accessible way to request accommodations and will work with the relevant University offices when needed. Leaders will make reasonable efforts to provide accessible meeting information, venues, and participation options.

Only enrolled UVA student members may vote or hold office. A student becomes eligible to vote after being on the roster for 14 days. This waiting period applies only to voting; it does not restrict membership or event access. Each eligible member has one vote. The roster will record join dates consistently and will not be changed to influence an election.

Guests may attend suitable activities but have no voting or officer rights. The organization will maintain the student membership and active participation levels required for CIO status. Leaders will keep an accurate roster and event attendance record; signing up for a mailing list alone does not count as regular participation.

Members may leave at any time. Graduation or loss of student enrollment ends voting and officer eligibility. Any action to suspend or remove membership for misconduct requires written grounds, at least seven days' notice, a chance to respond, and a two-thirds vote at a meeting with quorum. The affected member does not vote on the decision. Urgent safety issues will be referred to the appropriate University office; internal procedures do not replace University processes.

Article IV - Officers

The elected officers are President, Vice-President, and Treasurer. They must be students enrolled on Grounds at UVA and remain eligible under current University rules. Each office is held by a different person.

President: Convene meetings; coordinate the program and officer work; act as the main University contact; oversee required registration, training, and renewal; maintain continuity; and ensure that commitments are approved before they are made.

Vice-President: Support the President; coordinate member welcome and events; maintain the roster, meeting notices, minutes, and attendance records; and perform the President's routine duties during a temporary absence.

Treasurer: Prepare budgets; maintain receipts and a transaction record; monitor available funds and funding restrictions; coordinate approved payment requests; give financial reports; and transfer records and authorized financial access during handover.

Officers may assign limited volunteer tasks to members. A volunteer task does not create a new elected office or grant authority to spend money, sign contracts, or access private member information without approval.

Article V - Elections

Regular elections take place each March. Officers give members at least 14 days' notice of nominations, eligibility rules, the election date, and how to vote. Any eligible voting member who meets officer requirements may nominate themselves or consent to nomination.

Elections use a secret ballot and provide an accessible remote option. An eligible member who is not a candidate administers the vote. Quorum is more than half of eligible voting members. A candidate wins by receiving more than half of valid votes cast for that office. If no candidate does, a runoff is held between the top two candidates. A tied result is resolved by another ballot after members have an opportunity to hear from the tied candidates. Results and vote totals are recorded without identifying individual ballots.

Terms run from May 1 through April 30. Outgoing and incoming officers complete handover in April. Members may reelect an eligible officer.

A vacancy is filled by special election within 30 days when the academic calendar permits. If a break prevents an election, hold it within 14 days after classes resume. Give at least seven days' notice for a special election. The elected replacement serves the rest of the term.

During a vacancy, the remaining officers may appoint an eligible student to perform essential duties temporarily. A temporary appointment does not remove the requirement for a special election or permit one person to approve their own expenses.

At least three eligible voting members may submit a written request for an officer's removal. Grounds include serious misconduct, misuse of funds, or repeated failure to perform the duties in this constitution.

Give the officer the written grounds at least seven days before the removal vote and an opportunity to respond. An uninvolved member chairs the process. The affected officer does not chair or vote on their own removal. Removal requires at least two-thirds of valid votes cast by eligible members, with the normal quorum met. Record the decision while limiting disclosure of private information.

Fill a resulting vacancy through this article. Refer urgent safety concerns and suspected policy violations to the appropriate University office. Do not conduct an internal process in a way that obstructs an official investigation.

Article VI - Meetings

The organization holds founder talks and Q&A sessions on Thursdays at 6 p.m. at The Foundry on Elliewood Avenue or Olsson 103. Officers announce the venue for each meeting. Shared work sessions and project demonstrations may be scheduled to support members' projects. Officers publish dates, times, locations, access details, and changes through the club's communication channels.

Hold at least one general business meeting each semester. Give at least seven days' notice of a business vote unless a longer period is required elsewhere in this constitution. A majority of eligible voting members is quorum. Ordinary decisions pass by a majority of valid votes cast. Elections, removal, amendments, and dissolution use their specific rules.

Members may ask for a business meeting by a written request from at least three eligible voting members. Officers schedule it within 14 days when classes are in session. Keep minutes of decisions and make them available to members, with private details removed where necessary.

Project participation is voluntary. Members retain ownership of their own work unless they make a separate informed agreement. The club does not require an equity share, transfer of intellectual property, public disclosure of private project material, or use of a particular paid tool as a condition of membership.

Article VII - Finance

There are no required membership dues. Any change to this rule requires a constitutional amendment before dues are collected. Financial hardship must not be used to exclude students from core participation.

The organization will not request or use SAF or Cav Funds during the 2026-2027 academic year. Potential sources include permitted fundraising and voluntary donations. These are possible sources, not claims that funds have been received. Accept funds only under rules the club can meet, and do not offer sponsors control of membership, officer selection, or member projects.

Funds may support club trips, including a possible trip to San Francisco, and travel, lodging, and related costs for visiting speakers. Each activity requires an approved budget and must meet the funding source's restrictions. No trip, expense, or award is guaranteed.

The Treasurer presents a proposed budget for member approval each semester and reports income, spending, commitments, and balance at least once per semester. Spending must remain within available funds and applicable funding restrictions.

Two officers who are not the payee must approve each expense in advance. If fewer than two officers can act without a conflict, obtain approval from eligible voting members at a meeting with quorum before committing funds. No person may approve their own reimbursement. Keep itemized receipts, approval records, and account records. Use direct vendor payment when available and suitable.

Club funds are kept in an organization account separate from personal accounts. Officers must complete the account and University payment setup required for the intended funding route before making requests. Do not assume that an allocation, pending reimbursement, or requested grant is cash available to spend.

Officers may not incur debt, lend club funds to members, or enter a contract beyond an approved budget without a separate member vote and any required University review. All financial and contractual authority remains subject to applicable policy and law.

Article VIII - Bylaws

The following bylaws govern conduct, records, officer transition, and dissolution. Any voting member may propose a bylaw in writing. Adoption or change requires seven days' notice and a majority of valid votes at a meeting with quorum. Bylaws cannot conflict with this constitution.

Hazing, coercion, harassment, and discrimination are prohibited. Participation in all activities is voluntary. The organization will comply with applicable University policies and event requirements, including those for minors when relevant.

Officers will collect only the member information needed to operate the club and meet registration requirements. Access is limited to people who need it for their duties. Do not share a private roster, publish member contact details, or record and publish identifiable participants without the needed permission. Use approved University reporting channels for safety concerns.

Before events, officers check venue access, capacity, accessibility, and any required approvals. If an event includes non-UVA children, travel, or other activities with additional rules, officers confirm those rules before the activity takes place.

In April, outgoing officers transfer the roster, minutes, event plans, approved constitution, budget, receipts, account records, and access to organization-controlled services through secure methods. Complete required training, update authorized roles, and remove obsolete access through the proper account process.

Dissolution requires at least 14 days' written notice and a two-thirds vote at a meeting with quorum. Settle lawful obligations and follow all restrictions on the return or transfer of grant funds. Remaining unrestricted funds will go to an eligible nonprofit or student organization chosen by the members, subject to applicable rules. No surplus is distributed to members. Close accounts and notify the relevant University office through the required process.

Article IX - Committees

The officers may form temporary committees for events or projects. Any member may volunteer. The officers appoint a willing member to coordinate each committee and set its task and end date. Committees report to the officers and cannot spend funds or make commitments without the approvals required by this constitution.

Article X - Advisors

The organization may choose an advisor by a majority vote at a meeting with quorum. Members may remove an advisor by a majority vote at a meeting with quorum after seven days' notice. No advisor has been appointed. An advisor may offer guidance but does not vote, hold a student office, control club funds, or bind the organization. This constitution does not establish a formal institutional partnership.

Collaborations with other clubs, The Foundry, or other resources must be described accurately. A link, guest appearance, or informal contact is not a formal partnership or endorsement.

Article XI - Amendments

Any voting member may propose an amendment in writing. Give all members the exact proposed text at least seven days before the vote. Adoption requires two-thirds of valid votes cast at a meeting with quorum. Record the date and approved version and update the University's copy where required.

Review this document each spring before renewal. Required policy updates must be incorporated through the applicable process and communicated to members.